

## Informational Text • Informational

|              |                |             |                            |
|--------------|----------------|-------------|----------------------------|
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Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

Firefighters are important members of the community. **Firefighters** gives readers information about these brave heroes, including the types of fires they fight, the equipment they use, and the training they need to become firefighters.

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# Firefighters



Written by Katie Knight

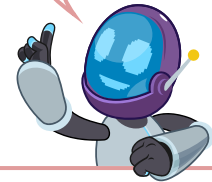
# Firefighters



Written by Katie Knight

## Focus Question

How do firefighters help keep us safe?



## Words to Know

|              |          |
|--------------|----------|
| firefighters | pump     |
| fuel         | spray    |
| machines     | training |

## Connections

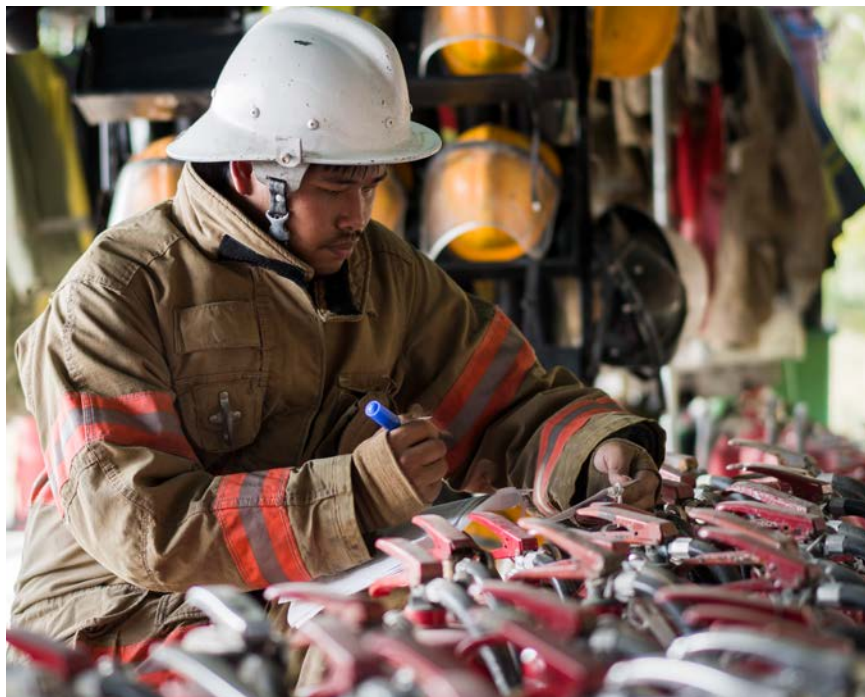
### Writing

Write a thank-you letter to firefighters. Tell them what you know about how they keep people safe. Ask the firefighters any questions you have about their job.

### Social Studies

Who are some other community helpers who help keep people safe? Draw and label a picture of at least three different community helpers.





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New York City firefighters leave the station.

## Introduction

Have you ever heard a fire truck racing to a fire?

**Firefighters** put out fires and save lives.

They help keep fires from starting.

They teach people about fire safety.



Firefighters teach children about fire safety in fun ways.

## What Makes Fire Burn

Fires need air to burn.

They also need **fuel**.

Wood and oil are two kinds of fuel.

The more fuel, the hotter  
the fire will be.

But even a candle flame  
burns very hot.

### Do You Know?

In our solar system, Earth is the only planet where fire can burn. Earth is the only planet with enough oxygen. Oxygen is a gas in the air.



Firefighters battle a fire in New York.

## Kinds of Fires

Firefighters put out fires in houses  
and tall buildings.

They also fight forest fires.

They must be ready to put out  
many kinds of fires.



## Firefighting Tools

Firefighters use many different tools. They use hoses to **spray** water or foam on fires. They break down doors with axes. They use ladders to reach high places.



Firefighters hold onto a powerful hose in Seychelles in East Africa (top). A firefighter climbs a ladder in India (bottom left). Firefighters use axes to fight a growing fire in the United Kingdom (bottom right).



Smoke masks protect firefighters from smoke. Fans move smoke from rooms. Fire extinguishers can put out small fires.

## Firefighting Machines

Fire trucks are important firefighting **machines**.

A fire engine has a **pump** to spray water.



The pump can spray water onto a fire from above.



Firefighters use a ladder truck to reach a fire.

Ladder trucks carry ladders.

Tanker trucks carry water.

Rescue trucks carry tools to help trapped people.



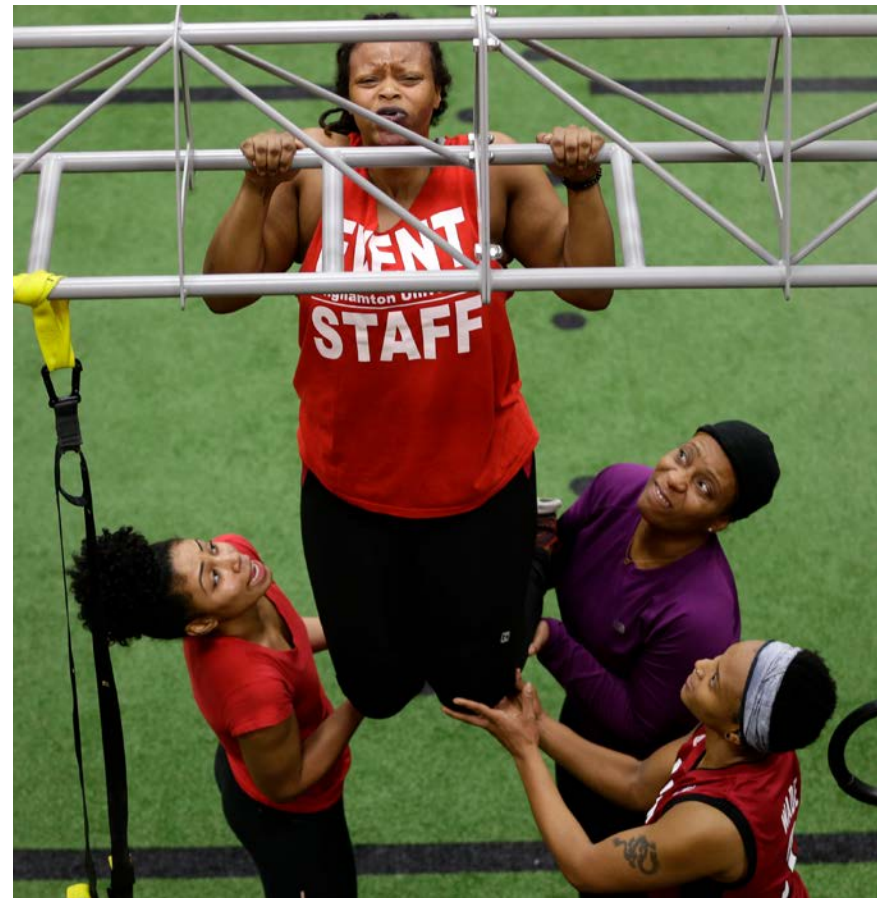
Other kinds of machines  
fight fires, too.  
Fireboats fight fires from the water.  
Helicopters drop water on fires.  
Planes help put out forest fires, too.



A fireboat sprays water onto a fire in Germany.



Sometimes planes drop water to put out fires. Sometimes they drop water to keep fires from starting.



Firefighters must be strong to do their jobs.

## Becoming a Firefighter

Firefighters must be at least  
eighteen years old.

They must be strong and  
in good shape.

They must also pass a written test.

Firefighters go to school for **training**.  
They learn how to fight  
different kinds of fires.  
They also learn how to treat  
hurt people.



Firefighters learn how to save people's lives.



Roasting marshmallows is a fun use of fire.

## Conclusion

Fire is useful, of course.  
People have used it to cook and  
stay warm for many thousands  
of years.  
At the same time, fire can be  
very dangerous.  
Fires take many lives  
and destroy forests.



Fires also destroy thousands of buildings every year.

Long ago, fires burned down entire cities.

Today, firefighters put out fires and keep us safe.



Firefighters risk their own lives to save the lives of others.

## Glossary

**firefighters** (n.) page 4

people whose work is putting out fires

**fuel** (n.) page 5

anything that is burned to produce heat or power

**machines** (n.) page 9

things that use energy to help a person do work

**pump** (n.) page 9

a machine that moves liquid or gas

**spray** (v.) page 7

to sprinkle or force out liquid in a mist or many small drops

**training** (n.) page 13

the teaching of a skill or way to act